

Newlife SDA Church – Office of the Church Clerk

Church Clerk Information System (CCIS)

Purpose

To seek the consent of the Church Board to **build the Newlife Church Clerk Information System (CCIS)**.

1. Background & Rationale

- **Mission & Governance** – The Office of the Church Clerk is central to the governance, documentation, and communication life of the Church. Accurate records and effective coordination strengthen spiritual care, transparency, and stewardship.
 - **Current Gap** – The current register holds **7,500+ names**, many without contact information. Records for meetings, policies, and events exist in disconnected files and folders.
 - **Global Context** – While the global **Adventist Church Management System (ACMS)** manages official membership integrity and transfers, it does **not** meet local operational needs.
The Newlife Church Clerk Information System (CCIS) will integrate with ACMS while providing comprehensive tools to manage membership, governance, life-event workflows, communication, and giving.
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2. Project Overview

System Scope

The CCIS will provide an integrated digital ecosystem that supports all functions of the Church Clerk's office, including:

A. Membership Management

- a. Live membership register (including Sabbath School).
- b. Transfers, baptisms, family units, and missing-member tracking.
- c. Year of baptism and birth records for verification matching.

B. Life-Event Services

- a. Workflows for weddings, baby dedications, and deaths.
- b. Certificate generation and status tracking.

C. Other Registers

The portal will include and link the following key registers, each designed to address specific record-keeping and engagement gaps in our congregation:

- a. Sabbath School Members
- b. Prayer Cells
- c. Church Officers/Workers
- d. Online Members
- e. Family Unit Records
- f. Departmental Members

D. Governance & Documentation

- a. **Board & Business Meetings:** Digital attendance, minutes, and action tracking.
- b. **Policy & Manual Repository:** Secure versioned archive of church policies (Finance, HR, Welfare, Transport, ICT, etc).
- c. **Committee Management:** Registry of committees, TORs, membership, and meeting records.
- d. **Action Tracker:** Follow-up dashboard for resolutions.
- e. **Annual Reporting Workflow:** Departmental report uploads and budget proposals.

E. Communication & Correspondence

- a. Broadcast announcements via WhatsApp, SMS, email, and newsletters.
- b. Board communication hub for internal correspondence.
- c. Event calendar integrated with departmental activities.
- d. Member correspondence log and tracking.

F. Records & Archiving

- a. Digital filing and archival system with retention schedules.
- b. Metadata tagging for historical document search.

G. Data Protection & Compliance

- a. Role-based access, ODPC compliance, secure storage, and access history.

H. Integration with ACMS

- a. Bidirectional synchronization for membership updates and transfers.

3. Data Protection

- **Legal Framework:** Kenya Data Protection Act (2019).
- **Compliance Lead:** Public Affairs & Religious Liberty (PARL) Director, serving as Data Protection & Privacy Officer.
- **Controls:** encryption, role-based access, audit logs, and data minimisation.

4. Implementation Timeline

Phase	Timeline	Key Activities
Preparation	Month 1	Data clean-up; data protection assessment; recruit expanded volunteer team; finalise technical design.
Core Build	Months 1–4	Build existing modules and integrate ACMS.
Governance & Documentation Module	Months 3–6	Build meetings, committees, and archive modules.
Pilot & Launch	Month 6 (up to 9 if contingency used)	Internal testing, validation, and initial rollout.

5. Team Structure & Volunteer Roles

The Newlife CCIS will be built by a core team of 16 volunteers who will contribute up to **6–8 hours weekly for 6 months**.

Core Team (6-Month Build)

Role	Count	Key Responsibilities
Project Coordinator (Church Clerk)	1	Lead vision, schedule, and Board reporting.
Product Manager	1	Translate vision to roadmap, coordinate cross-functional delivery of the system, manage roadmap, ensure timely delivery.
Product Designers	2	Create user-friendly, accessible designs that reflect Newlife's values.
Technical Lead / System Architect	1	Define tech stack, architecture, infrastructure, performance, security, and code quality.
Backend Developers	4	Develop APIs, database logic and governance tools.
Frontend Developers	3	Develop responsive interfaces and dashboards.
DevOps Engineer	1	Manage cloud hosting, backups, and deployment pipelines.
QA / Test Engineer	1	Develop and execute test plans; ensure reliability and stability.
Admin Support	1	Support document migration, archival organization.

Role	Count	Key Responsibilities
PARL Director (Data Protection & Privacy Officer)	1	Ensure ODPC compliance, oversee access controls, and conduct privacy impact reviews.

6. Future Enhancements

- Mobile app for members.
 - Build departmental workflows and include departmental dashboards (e.g., Treasury, SPIC, Welfare).
 - Smart analytics and reporting tools for Board decisions.
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7. Budget

The project will be entirely volunteer run. The cloud-hosting costs for the complete CCIS will be covered under the annual budget of the Office of the Church Clerk.

Prepared by:

Office of the Church Clerk (Project Coordinator)

Date: _____

(Signature Line)

Church Clerk

(Signature Line)

Elder in Charge